

Post-incident review PIR-2026-024

Search Service: failed sign-ins

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 29 January 2026, Search Service experienced failed sign-ins in production (AU Southeast) for about 160 minutes. The error-rate alert paged the on-call engineer. Investigation found that a gateway routing rule was updated to send traffic to a new backend pool that had not been warmed up.

Impact

Users of Search Service saw failed sign-ins for about 160 minutes. The service owner, Digital Channels, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:13 First signal received.
- 09:34 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:49 Likely cause identified.
- 10:01 Mitigation applied.
- 10:58 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that a gateway routing rule was updated to send traffic to a new backend pool that had not been warmed up.

Capacity dashboards were checked early and showed normal headroom.

All traffic depended on one component with no standby.

The expected load had not been tested before release.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Load test the service at twice the expected peak before the next campaign.
- Write and rehearse a runbook for this failure mode.
- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.